

HUMAN DIGNITY FOUNDATION

CONSTITUTION

ARTICLE 1: PREAMBLE

- ✓ We, the members of the Human Dignity Foundation, establish this Constitution to give a lawful structure to an Organisation formed to defend the inherent worth of every human being.
 - ✓ We recognise the equal standing of men and women, and we commit to protecting each person from discrimination, abuse, and conduct that undermines their dignity.
 - ✓ We acknowledge the need for a firm foundation built on integrity, accountability, and fairness.
 - ✓ We accept the responsibility to guard this Organisation from personal gain, bias toward one gender, or actions that weaken public trust.
 - ✓ We affirm that our work serves the public good, not private interest.
 - ✓ We set out this Constitution to clarify our name, nature, identity, symbols, and principles.
 - ✓ We adopt these elements as binding markers of who we are and how we operate.
 - ✓ We recognise that our symbols and colors carry meaning, and that misuse of our identity harms the mission we are sworn to protect.
 - ✓ We commit to operate as a non-profit body guided by lawful standards at all times.
 - ✓ We recognise that justice requires restraint, honesty, and equal treatment.
 - ✓ We accept that every member and leader carries the duty to uphold these standards without exception.
 - ✓ With this understanding, we adopt this Constitution as the governing document of the Human Dignity Foundation, and we bind ourselves to its provisions for the protection and advancement of human dignity.
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ARTICLE 2: NAME, NATURE, INTEGRITY, LOGO, AND SYMBOLIC IDENTITY, AND GUIDING PRINCIPLES

SECTION 2.1 NAME

- ✓ The organization will be legally recognized as Human Dignity Foundation.
 - ✓ The name is the official and lawful identity of the organization to be used in all documentation, records, proceedings, and engagements.
 - ✓ No Member/Leader is permitted to use the name of the organization for personal gain, private business, or any action outside the mandate of the organization.
 - ✓ The name shall appear only on official documents, programs, communications and materials authorized by the governing council.
 - ✓ Any procedure to alter or amend the name shall follow the formal amendment procedure set out in the constitution.
 - ✓ No individual or leader may change or claim the name for personal use.
 - ✓ A name change takes effect only after a full membership decision.
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SECTION 2.2 NATURE

- ✓ The organization stands as a lawful, non-governmental, non-profit, and non-political body.
- ✓ The organization serves both men and women with equal attention.
- ✓ No Leader/Member should use the organization to seek income or turn the organization's programs into a private source of income.
- ✓ The organization protects every person without leaning towards one gender; any form of bias towards one side harms its mandate, and such conduct becomes a breach of duty
- ✓ The organization observes national laws in every action and holds a duty to operate with order, fairness, and respect for human rights; thus, members act within these rules at all times.

- ✓ The organization acts through service and avoids personal interests and political influence. It avoids activities that shift the mission away from dignity and protection.
 - ✓ Any attempt to twist the nature of the foundation for private gain or personal advantage triggers firm corrective action. The foundation guards its mandate with discipline and clarity.
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SECTION 2.3 INTEGRITY

- ✓ The organization upholds integrity as a binding standard for all members and leaders
 - ✓ Each Member/Leader must act with honesty, accuracy and fairness in every decision and engagement.
 - ✓ Each Member/Leader should avoid conduct that misleads, exploits or create undue advantage.
 - ✓ Each Member/Leader must present information truthfully and maintain transparency in all duties.
 - ✓ Each Member/Leader must keep clear records to support any action taken on behalf of the organization. No person will engage in unlawful shortcuts, manipulation of processes, or suppression of facts. Any attempt to alter minutes, falsify reports or or conceal material information violates this provision.
 - ✓ Leaders hold a higher duty. They must declare conflicts of interest, step back from decisions where their neutrality is compromised, and avoid favoritism linked to gender, identity, or personal alliance.
 - ✓ Members must protect confidentiality, respect procedure, and follow the law. Integrity demands discipline. You must correct errors quickly, address misconduct without bias, and submit grievances through the lawful channel provided by the constitution.
 - ✓ Breach of integrity invites investigation and disciplinary actions. Repeated violations trigger removal from office or membership as provided under the enforcement procedure.
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SECTION 2.4 LOGO AND SYMBOLIC IDENTITY

- ✓ The organization's logo and symbolic identity represent our purpose, values, and standings in the community. The symbols form a protected identity. You must treat them with respect and use them only in ways permitted under this constitution
- ✓ The official logo carries a shield containing a dual profile showing both man and woman, symbolizing shared humanity. Laurel branches surround the shield to represent honor and integrity.
- ✓ The name represents human worth, shared responsibility and equal protection of every person.
- ✓ The logo carries the Organisation's colors, green, purple, red, gold, and blue. These colors mark unity, resilience, accountability, justice, and truth. No member may alter these colors or create a substitute version for personal branding or private use. Any adjustment to the logo, name, or colors requires approval through the authorised amendment procedure.
- ✓ The Organisation's name and visual identity remain collective property. No person has ownership rights over them. You must not register the name for personal business, profit, or independent projects. You must not attach the logo to merchandise or services for personal gain. Use of the logo in partnerships or public events must follow the procedure set by the Governing Council.
- ✓ Members must protect the identity from distortion. You must avoid actions that mislead the public into believing the Organisation supports unauthorised activities. Any member who issues statements, posts material, or engages online under the Organisation's name must follow the communication rules.
- ✓ If a member seeks to change their own name or identity in a manner relating to the Organisation's functions, they must file a formal notice. The Governing Council must confirm that the change respects legal requirements, internal records, and symbolic consistency.
- ✓ Any attempt to commercialise the Organisation's identity, misrepresent its symbols, or use them in a manner that creates private benefit amounts to

misconduct. Disciplinary action will follow as prescribed under the enforcement procedures.

ARTICLE 3: VISION, MISSION, VALUES, AND OBJECTIVES

SECTION 3.1 VISION

- ✓ The Human Dignity Foundation envisions a society where every individual, male and female, enjoys full human dignity, equal rights, and opportunities.
 - ✓ The Foundation seeks a community free from discrimination, oppression, and marginalization, where all people are respected and empowered to live fulfilling lives.
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SECTION 3.2 MISSION

- ✓ The Human Dignity Foundation exists to protect, promote, and defend the dignity and rights of all individuals.
 - ✓ The Foundation undertakes advocacy, education, and empowerment programs to fight inequality, abuse, and exploitation.
 - ✓ The Foundation actively engages with communities, government agencies, and other stakeholders to influence policies and practices that uphold human rights.
 - ✓ The Foundation provides guidance, support, and intervention where human rights are threatened or violated.
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SECTION 3.3 VALUES

- ✓ **Respect:** All individuals have inherent worth; all actions of the Foundation shall honor human dignity.
- ✓ **Equality:** The Foundation shall ensure that males and females receive equal treatment, access, and opportunities in all its activities.
- ✓ **Integrity:** Members and leadership shall act honestly, transparently, and ethically in all matters.

- ✓ **Empowerment:** Communities and individuals shall be supported to understand and exercise their rights.
 - ✓ **Accountability:** The Foundation and its members shall take responsibility for decisions, actions, and outcomes.
 - ✓ **Collaboration:** The Foundation shall work with stakeholders to strengthen human rights protections and achieve shared goals.
 - ✓ **Inclusivity:** Programs and interventions shall be accessible, participatory, and sensitive to vulnerable or marginalized groups.
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SECTION 3.4 OBJECTIVES

- ✓ To uphold and defend human dignity for all individuals, protecting both males and females from discrimination, abuse, and exploitation.
 - ✓ To advocate for equal rights and opportunities, ensuring that policies, laws, and social practices respect gender equality.
 - ✓ To educate communities and individuals about their rights and responsibilities, promoting awareness of human dignity and equality.
 - ✓ To provide guidance and support to victims of abuse, exploitation, or discrimination, including legal, social, and psychological assistance.
 - ✓ To intervene in cases where human dignity is violated, working to prevent further harm and restore justice.
 - ✓ To promote ethical leadership and responsible governance at all levels of the Foundation's operations.
 - ✓ To establish monitoring mechanisms that track adherence to human rights standards and the Foundation's internal policies.
 - ✓ To develop programs that empower communities to participate in decision-making processes affecting their lives.
 - ✓ To collaborate with governmental and non-governmental organizations, civil society, and community groups to advance human dignity and equality.
 - ✓ To create policies and procedures that anticipate challenges, such as discrimination, marginalization, or inequality, and provide clear steps for response and resolution.
 - ✓ To ensure all activities of the Foundation are inclusive, transparent, and accountable to beneficiaries, partners, and the wider public.
 - ✓ To continuously assess and improve strategies to promote dignity, equality, and human rights.
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- ✓ To serve as a consistent and guiding voice for underrepresented, vulnerable, and marginalized groups in society.
 - ✓ To document and communicate lessons learned from advocacy, intervention, and empowerment initiatives to strengthen future operations.
 - ✓ To uphold these objectives as binding principles for all members, staff, volunteers, and leadership of the Foundation, ensuring that the organization's mission and values guide all actions consistently over time.
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ARTICLE 4: MEMBERSHIP

SECTION 4.1 ELIGIBILITY

- Membership in the Human Dignity Foundation is open to any individual who supports the vision, mission, values, and objectives of the Foundation.
 - Applicants must be of legal age as defined by national law, of sound character, and committed to promoting human dignity, equality, and human rights.
 - Individuals involved in criminal activities, discriminatory practices, or acts contrary to the Foundation's values shall not be eligible.
 - Membership is open without discrimination based on gender, religion, ethnicity, social status, or political affiliation.
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SECTION 4.2 CATEGORIES OF MEMBERSHIP

1. Founding Members:

- ✓ Individuals who established the Human Dignity Foundation and contributed to its initial development.
- ✓ Hold permanent membership with special recognition and advisory rights within the Foundation.

2. Ordinary Members:

- ✓ Individuals actively engaged in programs, advocacy, and community activities.
- ✓ Have voting rights and may stand for leadership positions within the Foundation.

3. Associate Members:

- ✓ Individuals or organizations that support the Foundation through financial contributions, technical expertise, or advisory services.

- ✓ Participate in activities and provide input, but may have limited voting rights.

4. Honorary Members:

- ✓ Persons recognized for exceptional contributions to human rights, gender equality, or human dignity.
- ✓ Nominated and approved by the Board; enjoy recognition and limited privileges but not voting rights.

5. Youth Members:

- ✓ Individuals under a defined age actively participating in Foundation initiatives, mentorship programs, or advocacy.
- ✓ Encouraged to participate in decision-making forums tailored to youth engagement.

SECTION 4.3 RIGHTS OF MEMBERS

- ✓ To participate in meetings, forums, workshops, and programs according to membership category.
- ✓ To receive information about the Foundation's policies, programs, and performance reports.
- ✓ To propose initiatives, provide feedback, and contribute to strategic planning.
- ✓ To vote in elections and hold office, where eligible.
- ✓ To receive recognition for contributions and access support from the Foundation.

SECTION 4.4 DUTIES OF MEMBERS

- ✓ To uphold and promote the values, mission, and objectives of the Foundation.
- ✓ To participate actively in programs, meetings, and activities.
- ✓ To respect fellow members, stakeholders, and beneficiaries, promoting inclusivity and equality.
- ✓ To comply with the Foundation's policies, procedures, and code of conduct.
- ✓ To report any misconduct or activities contrary to the Foundation's values.
- ✓ To contribute to the sustainability, growth, and reputation of the Foundation.

SECTION 4.5 LOSS OF MEMBERSHIP

Membership may be terminated under the following circumstances:

- ✓ **Misconduct or Violation of Values:** Any act that contradicts the Foundation's vision, mission, or code of conduct, including discrimination, harassment, corruption, or criminal behaviour.
 - ✓ **Non-Compliance with Duties:** Failure to participate, neglect of responsibilities, or repeated absence from mandatory meetings or programs.
 - ✓ **Breach of Confidentiality or Trust:** Sharing sensitive information without authorization or acting against the interests of the Foundation.
 - ✓ **Actions Against the Reputation of the Foundation:** Any activity that damages the credibility or public image of the Foundation.
 - ✓ **Voluntary Resignation:** A member may resign by submitting written notice to the Secretariat, subject to formal acknowledgment.
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SECTION 4.6 REINSTATEMENT

- ✓ Former members may apply for reinstatement after a specified period, subject to approval by the Board.
 - ✓ Reinstatement shall depend on demonstrated commitment to the Foundation's values and fulfillment of any conditions set by the Board.
 - ✓ Reinstated members regain rights and responsibilities according to their membership category.
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ARTICLE 5: ORGANS OF THE ORGANIZATION

The Human Dignity Foundation shall operate through the following organs, each with defined roles, responsibilities, and powers to ensure proper governance, accountability, and execution of the Foundation's mandate.

SECTION 5.1 GENERAL ASSEMBLY

- ✓ The General Assembly is the supreme decision-making organ of the Foundation.
- ✓ Composed of all members in good standing, including founding, ordinary, associate, youth, and honorary members (with voting rights as applicable).

Functions:

- ✓ Approve policies, strategic plans, and major programs.
 - ✓ Elect members to the Executive Council and other leadership positions.
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- ✓ Receive and approve annual reports, audits, and financial statements.
- ✓ Ratify amendments to the constitution and major organizational changes.

Meetings:

- ✓ Held at least once annually, with extraordinary meetings convened as necessary.
 - ✓ Decisions are made by majority vote, except for constitutional amendments which require a higher threshold as defined in the constitution.
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SECTION 5.2 EXECUTIVE COUNCIL

- ✓ The Executive Council is responsible for governance, oversight, and strategic direction of the Foundation.
- ✓ Composed of elected officials:
 - Chairperson
 - Vice-Chairperson
 - Secretary
 - Vice Secretary (elected by the Secretary)
 - Treasurer (elected by founding members)
 - Public Relations Officer and Vice Public Relations Officer
 - Outreach and Partnership Officer and Vice Outreach and Partnership Officer
 - Welfare Officer and Vice Welfare Officer
 - Flame of Fairness Officer and Vice Flame of Fairness Officer

Functions:

- ✓ Implement policies approved by the General Assembly.
- ✓ Oversee programs, projects, and initiatives.
- ✓ Manage resources, finances, and ensure accountability.
- ✓ Serve as a liaison between the General Assembly, Secretariat, and project units.
- ✓ Make recommendations on membership matters, disciplinary issues, and strategic partnerships.

- ✓ Ensure adherence to the Foundation's vision, mission, values, and objectives.
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SECTION 5.3 SECRETARIAT

- ✓ The Secretariat is the administrative organ responsible for day-to-day operations of the Foundation.
- ✓ Headed by the Secretary, supported by staff and volunteers.

Functions:

- ✓ Implement decisions of the Executive Council and General Assembly.
 - ✓ Maintain official records, membership registers, and communications.
 - ✓ Coordinate programs, events, and advocacy initiatives.
 - ✓ Prepare reports, proposals, and budgets for review by the Executive Council.
 - ✓ Ensure compliance with organizational policies, laws, and ethical standards.
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SECTION 5.4 ADVISORY BOARD

- ✓ The Advisory Board consists of experienced individuals, experts, and leaders in human rights, gender equality, social justice, and governance.

Functions:

- ✓ Provide guidance and recommendations to the Executive Council and General Assembly.
 - ✓ Offer technical expertise in program development, policy advocacy, and organizational strategy.
 - ✓ Support conflict resolution and ethical decision-making within the Foundation.
 - ✓ Act as ambassadors for the Foundation, enhancing credibility and partnerships.
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SECTION 5.5 PROJECT UNITS AND COMMITTEES

- ✓ The Foundation may establish specialized units or committees to implement specific programs, projects, or activities.
- ✓ **Examples:** Education and Advocacy Committee, Legal Support Unit, Community Empowerment Unit, Finance and Audit Committee.

Functions:

- ✓ Plan, execute, and monitor assigned projects or programs.
 - ✓ Report progress, challenges, and outcomes to the Secretariat and Executive Council.
 - ✓ Ensure participation and accountability of members involved in specific projects.
 - ✓ Develop recommendations for scaling successful initiatives or addressing gaps.
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Section 5.6 General Principles for All Organs

- ✓ Each organ shall operate in alignment with the Foundation's vision, mission, values, and objectives.
 - ✓ Decisions shall be transparent, ethical, and in the best interest of the Foundation and its beneficiaries.
 - ✓ Clear communication and coordination between organs are mandatory to ensure efficiency and avoid duplication.
 - ✓ Each organ is accountable to the General Assembly and, ultimately, to the Foundation's members and stakeholders.
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ARTICLE 6: FUNCTIONS OF THE ORGANS

SECTION 6.1 POWERS OF THE GENERAL ASSEMBLY

- ✓ Approve and adopt the Foundation's strategic plans, policies, and programs.
 - ✓ Elect members to the Executive Council and other leadership positions.
 - ✓ Approve annual budgets, financial statements, and audit reports.
 - ✓ Ratify amendments to the constitution or major organizational changes.
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- ✓ Make decisions on membership matters, including admission, suspension, or expulsion.
 - ✓ Serve as the final authority on disputes, appeals, or complaints regarding the Foundation's operations.
 - ✓ Set priorities and direction for the Foundation's activities.
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SECTION 6.2 POWERS OF THE EXECUTIVE COUNCIL

- ✓ Implement policies and decisions approved by the General Assembly.
 - ✓ Supervise and coordinate the activities of the Secretariat and project units.
 - ✓ Approve projects, programs, and partnerships, ensuring alignment with the Foundation's mission and objectives.
 - ✓ Manage financial resources, including allocation of funds, approval of expenditures, and oversight of accounting procedures.
 - ✓ Make recommendations to the General Assembly on organizational development, membership, and disciplinary matters.
 - ✓ Monitor performance and ensure accountability of all members, staff, and officers.
 - ✓ Serve as the decision-making body between General Assembly meetings for urgent or operational matters.
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Section 6.3 Duties of the Secretariat

- ✓ Implement the decisions of the Executive Council and General Assembly efficiently and effectively.
- ✓ Maintain records, membership registers, and official correspondence.
- ✓ Prepare reports, proposals, budgets, and financial statements for review by the Executive Council.
- ✓ Coordinate all programs, events, advocacy campaigns, and community initiatives.
- ✓ Ensure compliance with internal policies, laws, and ethical standards.
- ✓ Facilitate communication between the Executive Council, General Assembly, project units, and committees.
- ✓ Support monitoring and evaluation of programs to track progress and outcomes.

SECTION 6.4 ROLE OF THE ADVISORY BOARD

- ✓ Provide expert guidance and recommendations to the Executive Council and General Assembly.
 - ✓ Offer technical support and strategic advice in program development, policy advocacy, and organizational governance.
 - ✓ Assist in conflict resolution, ethical decision-making, and risk management.
 - ✓ Promote the Foundation's reputation and credibility through advocacy, representation, and networking.
 - ✓ Review and advise on major initiatives, ensuring alignment with the Foundation's vision, mission, and values.
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SECTION 6.5 DUTIES OF COMMITTEES AND PROJECT UNITS

- ✓ Plan, implement, and monitor projects or programs assigned to them.
- ✓ Ensure participation and accountability of members involved in their respective units.
- ✓ Report progress, challenges, and outcomes to the Secretariat and Executive Council.
- ✓ Develop recommendations for improvement, scaling, or modification of programs.
- ✓ Ensure that activities adhere to the Foundation's values, policies, and strategic objectives.
- ✓ Facilitate engagement with beneficiaries, communities, and stakeholders to maximize impact.

SECTION 6.6 GENERAL PRINCIPLES

- ✓ All organs shall operate in a transparent, accountable, and ethical manner.
- ✓ Each organ shall ensure coordination and communication with other organs to prevent duplication and inefficiency.
- ✓ Decisions of each organ are binding within their scope of authority but remain accountable to the General Assembly.

- ✓ Each organ shall act in the best interest of the Foundation and its beneficiaries, upholding the vision, mission, and objectives at all times.
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ARTICLE 7: OFFICE BEARERS

SECTION 7.1 LIST OF OFFICES

The Office Bearers of the Human Dignity Foundation shall include:

- Chairperson
 - Vice-Chairperson
 - Secretary
 - Vice Secretary (elected by the Secretary)
 - Treasurer (elected by founding members)
 - Public Relations Officer and Vice Public Relations Officer
 - Outreach and Partnership Officer and Vice Outreach and Partnership Officer
 - Welfare Officer and Vice Welfare Officer
 - Flame of Fairness Officer and Vice Flame of Fairness Officer
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SECTION 7.2 POWERS OF EACH OFFICE

Chairperson

- ✓ Preside over meetings of the General Assembly and Executive Council.
- ✓ Represent the Foundation in all official matters and legal proceedings.
- ✓ Provide overall leadership and direction to the Foundation.

Vice-Chairperson

- ✓ Assist the Chairperson and perform duties in their absence.
- ✓ Coordinate specific projects or initiatives as delegated by the Chairperson.

Secretary

- ✓ Maintain official records, membership registers, and correspondence.
- ✓ Convene and manage meetings of the Executive Council and General Assembly.

- ✓ Ensure implementation of decisions made by the Executive Council.

Vice Secretary

- ✓ Assist the Secretary in all duties and assume responsibilities during their absence.
- ✓ Maintain supplementary records and reports as assigned by the Secretary.

Treasurer

- ✓ Manage and oversee all financial resources of the Foundation.
- ✓ Prepare budgets, financial statements, and reports for the Executive Council and General Assembly.
- ✓ Ensure proper financial controls and accountability.

Public Relations Officer

- ✓ Manage internal and external communications of the Foundation.
- ✓ Promote the image, programs, and initiatives of the Foundation.
- ✓ Liaise with media and stakeholders to enhance visibility.

Vice Public Relations Officer

- ✓ Assist the Public Relations Officer and act in their absence.
- ✓ Support communications, campaigns, and stakeholder engagement.

Outreach and Partnership Officer

- ✓ Identify and manage partnerships with organizations, communities, and stakeholders.
- ✓ Develop outreach programs to expand the Foundation's influence and impact.

Vice Outreach and Partnership Officer

- ✓ Assist the Outreach and Partnership Officer and act in their absence.
- ✓ Support partnership development and community engagement activities.

Welfare Officer

- ✓ Oversee welfare programs for members, beneficiaries, and communities.
- ✓ Ensure that social support initiatives are effectively implemented.

Vice Welfare Officer

- ✓ Assist the Welfare Officer and act in their absence.
- ✓ Support monitoring and implementation of welfare programs.

Flame of Fairness Officer

- ✓ Promote equality, fairness, and accountability in all Foundation activities.
- ✓ Monitor adherence to ethical standards and values in programs and operations.

Vice Flame of Fairness Officer

- ✓ Assist the Flame of Fairness Officer and act in their absence.
 - ✓ Support oversight of fairness and ethical compliance in programs and activities.
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SECTION 7.3 DUTIES OF EACH OFFICE

- ✓ All office bearers must act in accordance with the Foundation's vision, mission, values, and objectives.
 - ✓ Office bearers shall attend meetings, participate actively in programs, and ensure accountability in their respective roles.
 - ✓ All office bearers must report regularly to the Executive Council and General Assembly on activities and outcomes.
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SECTION 7.4 TERM OF OFFICE

- ✓ Each office bearer shall serve a term of **three (3) years**, renewable once upon approval of the General Assembly.
 - ✓ Terms shall begin immediately upon election or appointment and end upon completion of the term, resignation, or removal.
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SECTION 7.5 REMOVAL FROM OFFICE

- ✓ An office bearer may be removed for misconduct, violation of the Foundation's constitution, abuse of office, or failure to perform duties.
 - ✓ Removal requires a formal notice, opportunity for the office bearer to respond, and a decision by a two-thirds majority of the Executive Council or General Assembly as appropriate.
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SECTION 7.6 REPLACEMENT PROCEDURES

- ✓ In the event of vacancy due to resignation, removal, death, or incapacity, the following procedures apply:
 - Vice officers shall assume the position of their principal officer temporarily until formal election or appointment.
 - The Executive Council shall conduct a by-election or appointment in accordance with the constitution and within a reasonable period.
 - For offices without vice officers, the Executive Council shall nominate and approve a replacement for the remainder of the term.
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SECTION 7.7 GENERAL PRINCIPLES

- ✓ All office bearers shall exercise powers with accountability, transparency, and in the best interest of the Foundation.
 - ✓ Decisions made by office bearers within their authority shall uphold the Foundation's values, objectives, and reputation.
 - ✓ Succession planning and continuity must be maintained to ensure smooth operations and minimal disruption to programs.
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ARTICLE 8: MEETINGS

SECTION 8.1 ANNUAL GENERAL MEETING (AGM)

- ✓ The Annual General Meeting is the principal gathering of the General Assembly.

- ✓ Held at least once every calendar year to review the Foundation's performance, approve reports, budgets, and plans, and elect office bearers where applicable.
 - ✓ The AGM shall provide a forum for members to discuss strategic issues, review policies, and make decisions affecting the Foundation.
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SECTION 8.2 SPECIAL MEETINGS

- ✓ Special meetings may be convened by the Executive Council, Chairperson, or upon written request by at least one-third of members in good standing.
 - ✓ Purpose-specific meetings address particular matters, such as policy amendments, program approvals, or membership issues.
 - ✓ Decisions taken during special meetings are binding and reported at the next AGM.
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SECTION 8.3 EMERGENCY MEETINGS

- ✓ Emergency meetings may be called to address urgent matters requiring immediate attention, including crises, misconduct, or unforeseen operational issues.
 - ✓ Convened by the Chairperson, or in their absence, the Vice-Chairperson.
 - ✓ Emergency meetings may be conducted physically or virtually, provided proper notice is given to all relevant members.
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SECTION 8.4 QUORUM

- ✓ A quorum is required for any meeting to make decisions legally binding.
 - ✓ **General Assembly:** At least one-third of members in good standing must be present or represented.
 - ✓ **Executive Council:** At least fifty percent plus one of council members must be present.
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- ✓ **Committees and Project Units:** A majority of members assigned to the unit must be present.
 - ✓ If a quorum is not met, the meeting may be adjourned and reconvened within a specified period.
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SECTION 8.5 VOTING PROCEDURES

- ✓ Decisions shall generally be made by majority vote unless otherwise specified in the constitution.
 - ✓ Voting may be conducted by show of hands, secret ballot, or electronically, depending on the meeting type and sensitivity of the issue.
 - ✓ Each member with voting rights is entitled to one vote.
 - ✓ In case of a tie, the Chairperson or presiding officer shall cast the deciding vote.
 - ✓ For constitutional amendments or major organizational changes, a two-thirds majority of members present is required.
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SECTION 8.6 NOTICE OF MEETINGS

- ✓ Written notice of meetings, including agenda, date, time, and venue, shall be sent to all relevant members at least **fourteen (14) days** prior to the meeting.
 - ✓ Notices may be sent physically, via email, or other reliable communication channels.
 - ✓ In the case of emergency meetings, notice may be shorter but must be reasonable to allow participation.
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SECTION 8.7 RECORD KEEPING

- ✓ Accurate minutes shall be maintained for all meetings, including AGM, special meetings, emergency meetings, Executive Council meetings, and committee meetings.
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- ✓ Minutes shall record:
 - Date, time, and venue of the meeting.
 - Members present and absent.
 - Agenda items discussed.
 - Decisions made, votes cast, and action points assigned.
 - ✓ Minutes must be signed by the Secretary and Chairperson or presiding officer and stored securely for reference and accountability.
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SECTION 8.8 GENERAL PRINCIPLES

- ✓ All meetings shall be conducted in a transparent, orderly, and fair manner.
 - ✓ Decisions taken at properly convened meetings in line with quorum requirements are binding.
 - ✓ Members shall respect the rules of procedure, contribute constructively, and act in the best interest of the Foundation.
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ARTICLE 9: PROGRAMS AND ACTIVITIES

- ✓ The Human Dignity Foundation shall implement programs and activities aimed at promoting human dignity, equality, and protection for all individuals. These programs shall be guided by the Foundation's vision, mission, and objectives.
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SECTION 9.1 PROTECTION PROGRAMS

- ✓ Design and implement programs that protect individuals, both male and female, from abuse, discrimination, exploitation, and human rights violations.
 - ✓ Establish monitoring and response mechanisms to prevent harm and provide timely intervention.
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- ✓ Collaborate with relevant authorities, organizations, and community structures to safeguard members and beneficiaries.
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SECTION 9.2 SUPPORT SERVICES

- ✓ Provide counseling, legal aid, and psychosocial support to members and beneficiaries in need.
 - ✓ Establish helplines, referral systems, and resource centers to facilitate access to assistance.
 - ✓ Monitor the effectiveness of support services and ensure confidentiality and ethical standards.
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SECTION 9.3 EDUCATION AND OUTREACH

- ✓ Conduct educational programs, workshops, and seminars to raise awareness on human rights, gender equality, and the protection of human dignity.
 - ✓ Engage schools, communities, and institutions to disseminate information and promote behavioral change.
 - ✓ Develop and distribute educational materials in accessible formats for diverse audiences.
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SECTION 9.4 COMMUNITY ACTION

- ✓ Organize community-based initiatives that empower individuals and strengthen social cohesion.
 - ✓ Facilitate volunteer programs, mentorship, and skill-building activities to support local communities.
 - ✓ Encourage active participation of members and beneficiaries in planning and implementing community projects.
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SECTION 9.5 ADVOCACY

- ✓ Advocate for the protection of human rights, gender equality, and equitable treatment of all individuals.
 - ✓ Engage with government agencies, civil society, and international bodies to influence policies and practices.
 - ✓ Promote campaigns, petitions, and public awareness initiatives to address systemic issues and injustices.
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SECTION 9.6 POLICY INFLUENCE

- ✓ Participate in the development and review of policies, legislation, and regulations that affect human dignity and equality.
 - ✓ Provide research, recommendations, and technical input to policymakers and stakeholders.
 - ✓ Monitor the implementation and impact of policies to ensure alignment with the Foundation's mission.
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SECTION 9.7 CAPACITY BUILDING

- ✓ Strengthen the skills, knowledge, and effectiveness of members, staff, and community partners.
 - ✓ Conduct training, mentorship, and leadership development programs.
 - ✓ Foster organizational learning and innovation to enhance program delivery and impact.
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SECTION 9.8 GENERAL PRINCIPLES

- ✓ All programs and activities shall be implemented in alignment with the Foundation's values, objectives, and ethical standards.

- ✓ Programs shall be inclusive, transparent, and responsive to the needs of beneficiaries.
 - ✓ Regular monitoring, evaluation, and reporting shall be conducted to ensure effectiveness, accountability, and continuous improvement.
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ARTICLE 10: RIGHTS PROTECTION AND SAFETY POLICY

- ✓ The Human Dignity Foundation shall ensure the protection, safety, and rights of all individuals through clear rules, protocols, and support systems. These measures shall apply to members, beneficiaries, and communities engaged by the Foundation.
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SECTION 10.1 PROTECTION OF WOMEN

- ✓ Implement programs and measures to prevent violence, exploitation, abuse, and discrimination against women.
 - ✓ Establish safe spaces, reporting mechanisms, and intervention strategies for women at risk.
 - ✓ Promote women's participation in decision-making, leadership, and advocacy initiatives.
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SECTION 10.2 PROTECTION OF MEN

- ✓ Ensure men are protected from abuse, discrimination, and rights violations.
 - ✓ Provide counseling, support services, and referral mechanisms for men experiencing harm.
 - ✓ Encourage men's involvement in advocacy, mentorship, and programs promoting equality.
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SECTION 10.3 PROTECTION OF CHILDREN

- ✓ Safeguard children from exploitation, abuse, neglect, and harmful practices.
 - ✓ Implement child protection policies in all Foundation programs and projects.
 - ✓ Collaborate with authorities, schools, and communities to provide education, safety, and support for children.
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SECTION 10.4 ANTI-DISCRIMINATION RULES

- ✓ No individual shall be discriminated against based on gender, age, religion, ethnicity, social status, disability, or political affiliation.
 - ✓ Discrimination in any form is strictly prohibited in Foundation activities, programs, and decision-making.
 - ✓ Violations will be addressed through investigation and appropriate disciplinary measures.
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SECTION 10.5 ANTI-HARASSMENT RULES

- ✓ Harassment, including verbal, physical, sexual, or psychological abuse, is strictly prohibited.
 - ✓ Clear procedures for reporting harassment shall be in place and accessible to all members and beneficiaries.
 - ✓ All complaints will be treated confidentially, investigated promptly, and resolved fairly.
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SECTION 10.6 CONFIDENTIALITY

- ✓ All personal information of members, beneficiaries, and stakeholders shall be treated as confidential.
 - ✓ Disclosure of sensitive information is only permitted with proper authorization or when required by law.
-

- ✓ Staff, members, and volunteers must uphold confidentiality in all communications and reporting.
-

SECTION 10.7 SURVIVOR SUPPORT RULES

- ✓ Survivors of abuse, harassment, or discrimination shall have access to immediate and appropriate support services, including counseling, legal aid, and medical care.
 - ✓ Programs shall prioritize the safety, dignity, and autonomy of survivors.
 - ✓ Survivors shall not face retaliation, stigma, or exclusion from Foundation activities.
-

SECTION 10.8 GENERAL PRINCIPLES

- ✓ All protection and safety policies shall be guided by respect for human rights, dignity, and equality.
- ✓ The Foundation shall maintain systems for monitoring, reporting, and responding to rights violations.
- ✓ Education, awareness, and training shall be conducted regularly to ensure compliance and promote a safe environment for all.

ARTICLE 11: CODE OF CONDUCT

The Human Dignity Foundation shall maintain high standards of professionalism, ethics, and integrity among its members, office bearers, staff, and volunteers. The Code of Conduct guides behavior, accountability, and conflict resolution.

SECTION 11.1 EXPECTED BEHAVIOR

- ✓ Members, office bearers, and staff shall act with integrity, honesty, and respect in all activities.

- ✓ All persons representing the Foundation shall uphold its values, vision, and mission.
 - ✓ Individuals must avoid actions that compromise the Foundation's credibility, reputation, or objectives.
-

SECTION 11.2 CONFLICT OF INTEREST

- ✓ Members and office bearers must disclose any personal, financial, or professional interest that may conflict with the Foundation's objectives.
 - ✓ Individuals must recuse themselves from decisions or activities where a conflict exists.
 - ✓ Failure to declare conflicts of interest may result in disciplinary action or removal from office.
-

SECTION 11.3 MISUSE OF AUTHORITY

- ✓ Office bearers shall exercise authority responsibly and fairly.
 - ✓ Power shall not be used to intimidate, manipulate, or exploit members, beneficiaries, or stakeholders.
 - ✓ Misuse of authority will lead to investigation and potential disciplinary measures.
-

SECTION 11.4 RESPECT BETWEEN MEMBERS

- ✓ All members shall treat one another with dignity, courtesy, and fairness.
 - ✓ Harassment, intimidation, or discriminatory behavior is strictly prohibited.
 - ✓ Constructive dialogue, collaboration, and conflict resolution are encouraged at all times.
-

SECTION 11.5 HANDLING COMPLAINTS

- ✓ Complaints must be submitted in writing to the Secretariat, Executive Council, or designated complaints committee.
 - ✓ All complaints shall be investigated promptly, impartially, and confidentially.
 - ✓ Complainants shall be protected from retaliation, and outcomes shall be communicated clearly.
-

SECTION 11.6 DISCIPLINARY ACTIONS

- ✓ Violations of the Code of Conduct may result in warnings, suspension, removal from office, or expulsion, depending on severity.
 - ✓ Disciplinary procedures shall be fair, transparent, and consistent with the Foundation's constitution.
 - ✓ Decisions on disciplinary actions may be appealed to the General Assembly for review.
-

SECTION 11.7 GENERAL PRINCIPLES

- ✓ All members, office bearers, staff, and volunteers are expected to uphold the Foundation's integrity and values at all times.
 - ✓ The Code of Conduct applies in all Foundation-related activities, programs, and interactions with stakeholders.
 - ✓ Education, training, and awareness programs shall be conducted regularly to reinforce ethical behavior and accountability.
-

ARTICLE 12: FINANCE AND PROPERTY

The Human Dignity Foundation shall manage all financial and physical resources with transparency, accountability, and responsibility. All funds and property shall be used to advance the Foundation's mission.

SECTION 12.1 SOURCES OF FUNDS

- ✓ Funds originate from member contributions, donations, grants, fundraising activities, partnerships, and lawful income generating projects.
 - ✓ All sources must align with the Foundation's values and must not compromise its independence or integrity.
-

SECTION 12.2 MANAGEMENT OF FUNDS

- ✓ All funds belong to the Foundation and must support programs, administration, and operations.
-

- ✓ The Executive Council oversees financial management, while the Treasurer maintains records, prepares reports, and ensures compliance with policy.
 - ✓ Expenditures must follow approved budgets and require proper authorization.
-

SECTION 12.3 BANKING RULES

- ✓ All funds shall be deposited into official bank accounts registered in the Foundation's name.
 - ✓ Accounts shall require at least two signatories from approved office bearers.
 - ✓ Cash handling must be minimized and documented to prevent loss or misuse.
-

SECTION 12.4 BUDGETING

- ✓ The Treasurer shall prepare annual budgets in consultation with departments, committees, and program units.
 - ✓ The Executive Council shall review the budget before presenting it to the General Assembly for approval.
 - ✓ Adjustments must be documented, justified, and approved by relevant authorities.
-

SECTION 12.5 AUDITING

- ✓ Annual financial statements shall be audited by an independent and accredited auditor.
 - ✓ Audit reports shall be presented to the General Assembly for review and action.
 - ✓ Internal audits or financial reviews may be conducted periodically to strengthen accountability.
-

SECTION 12.6 ASSET OWNERSHIP

- ✓ All physical and intellectual property acquired by the Foundation belongs to the Foundation as a legal entity.
 - ✓ Assets must be recorded, tagged, and maintained under the custody of designated officers.
 - ✓ Disposal or transfer of assets requires approval from the Executive Council and proper documentation.
-

SECTION 12.7 USE OF PROPERTY

- ✓ Foundation property shall support official programs, administration, and activities.
 - ✓ Unauthorized use for personal benefit is prohibited and may result in disciplinary action.
 - ✓ Damage, loss, or misuse must be reported immediately to the Secretariat or Executive Council for investigation.
-

ARTICLE 13: PROJECTS AND PARTNERSHIPS

The Human Dignity Foundation shall implement structured projects and engage in partnerships that support its mission and strengthen its impact. All projects and collaborations must uphold accountability, transparency, and community benefit.

SECTION 13.1 PROJECT PLANNING

- ✓ Departments, committees, or members propose projects through written concepts outlining goals, timelines, budgets, and expected outcomes.
 - ✓ Planning must align with the Foundation's mission, available resources, and strategic direction.
 - ✓ Risk assessments, beneficiary needs, and sustainability considerations must guide all planning.
-

SECTION 13.2 PROJECT APPROVAL

- ✓ Proposed projects are submitted to the Executive Council for review.
 - ✓ Approval requires evaluation of relevance, feasibility, cost, and expected impact.
 - ✓ Projects involving significant financial commitments or external partners must also be endorsed by the General Assembly.
-

SECTION 13.3 COOPERATION WITH GROUPS

- ✓ The Foundation collaborates with community organizations, institutions, government bodies, and civil society groups that support its mission.
 - ✓ Cooperation must respect mutual values, shared goals, and lawful practice.
 - ✓ Joint activities require coordination, clear communication, and formal responsibility sharing.
-

SECTION 13.4 AGREEMENTS

- ✓ Partnerships must be formalized through written agreements that outline roles, obligations, financial responsibilities, duration, and expected outcomes.
 - ✓ Agreements must be reviewed by the Executive Council before signing.
 - ✓ Any agreement that affects the Foundation's legal or financial standing shall require approval from designated signatories.
-

SECTION 13.5 MONITORING AND EVALUATION

- ✓ All projects and partnerships must be monitored to track progress, use of resources, and adherence to objectives.
 - ✓ Evaluation reports must document achievements, challenges, lessons, and recommendations for improvement.
 - ✓ Findings shall be submitted to the Executive Council and General Assembly for accountability and planning.
-

ARTICLE 14: AMENDMENTS

The Human Dignity Foundation shall maintain a clear process for updating its constitution when needed to strengthen governance, accountability, and service to the community.

SECTION 14.1 WHO MAY PROPOSE AN AMENDMENT

- ✓ Any registered member in good standing may propose an amendment.
 - ✓ The Executive Council may propose amendments.
-

- ✓ Committees or the Advisory Board may submit recommendations through the Executive Council.
-

SECTION 14.2 AMENDMENT PROCEDURE

- ✓ A proposed amendment must be submitted in writing to the Secretariat.
 - ✓ The Secretariat circulates the proposal to all members for review within a set notice period.
 - ✓ Members receive time to study the proposal, ask questions, and provide feedback before voting.
 - ✓ The Executive Council presents the final version during a General Assembly meeting.
-

SECTION 14.3 VOTING THRESHOLD

- ✓ An amendment passes when two thirds of the eligible voters in the General Assembly approve it.
 - ✓ Only members in good standing participate in amendment decisions.
 - ✓ Abstentions do not count toward approval.
-

SECTION 14.4 ADOPTION

- ✓ Once approved, the amendment takes effect immediately unless the General Assembly sets a different start date.
 - ✓ The Secretariat updates all official documents and records.
 - ✓ Members receive a notice confirming the change.
-

ARTICLE 15: DISSOLUTION

The Human Dignity Foundation shall dissolve only under strict conditions that protect members, beneficiaries, and all assets held in trust for the public good.

SECTION 15.1 GROUNDS FOR DISSOLUTION

- ✓ The Foundation fails to meet its objectives because of loss of capacity or legal restrictions.
-

- ✓ Severe financial collapse prevents the continuation of programs.
 - ✓ Long term internal conflict harms operations and cannot be resolved.
 - ✓ A court orders dissolution after legal findings.
 - ✓ Members agree that the Foundation no longer serves its intended purpose.
-

SECTION 15.2 PROCESS OF DISSOLUTION

- ✓ A written motion for dissolution must be submitted to the Executive Council.
 - ✓ The Executive Council reviews the motion and calls a Special General Assembly meeting.
 - ✓ Members receive notice with reasons, proposed dates, and the full dissolution plan.
 - ✓ Dissolution occurs only if two thirds of eligible voters approve the motion.
 - ✓ Once approved, a Dissolution Committee is formed to manage all steps.
 - ✓ The committee settles debts, closes accounts, ends contracts, and finalizes staff obligations.
 - ✓ All moves are recorded and reported to the General Assembly.
-

SECTION 15.3 DISTRIBUTION OF ASSETS

- ✓ After settling liabilities, all remaining assets must support similar human rights or protection work.
 - ✓ Assets are transferred to another registered organization with aligned goals and strong integrity.
 - ✓ Members do not receive personal financial benefit.
 - ✓ The Secretariat files final reports with relevant authorities.
 - ✓ Records are archived for future reference.
-

ARTICLE 16: INTERPRETATION

This article guides how members, leaders, and stakeholders understand and apply the Constitution of the Human Dignity Foundation.

SECTION 16.1 DEFINITIONS

- ✓ Words used in the Constitution take their ordinary meaning unless defined by the Foundation.
 - ✓ Terms such as member, office bearer, Executive Council, General Assembly, and Secretariat refer to the specific roles stated in this Constitution.
 - ✓ Any term linked to gender, age, or status applies equally to all persons.
 - ✓ Where doubt appears, written clarification is required from the Secretariat or Executive Council.
-

SECTION 16.2 AUTHORITY TO INTERPRET

- ✓ The Executive Council holds the primary authority to interpret this Constitution.
 - ✓ If interpretation affects rights or duties, the matter is tabled before the General Assembly for confirmation.
 - ✓ The Advisory Board may offer guidance when interpretation affects ethics, long term policy, or legal compliance.
 - ✓ All interpretations must respect the Foundation's vision, mission, and values.
-

SECTION 16.3 APPLICATION OF THIS CONSTITUTION

- ✓ This Constitution applies to all members, office bearers, staff, volunteers, and partners.
 - ✓ All programs, meetings, financial decisions, and organizational actions must follow the rules in this Constitution.
 - ✓ If conflict arises between this Constitution and any internal policy, this Constitution takes priority.
 - ✓ The Foundation enforces all sections from the date of adoption.
 - ✓ All future amendments are included automatically once approved.
-

ARTICLE 17: ORGANIZATIONAL PROCESSES AND PROCEDURES

This article outlines all key procedures of the Human Dignity Foundation, ensuring consistency, fairness, and transparency in membership, leadership, governance, and decision-making.

SECTION 17.1 PROCESS OF MEMBERSHIP

- ✓ Prospective members submit an application to the Secretariat with personal details, identification, and proof of eligibility.
 - ✓ The Secretariat reviews the application and verifies documents.
 - ✓ The Executive Council approves or rejects the membership based on eligibility criteria.
 - ✓ Approved members are registered, issued membership IDs, and welcomed officially at a General Assembly or induction ceremony.
-

SECTION 17.2 PROCESS OF MEMBERSHIP TERMINATION

- ✓ Termination may occur due to resignation, misconduct, non-compliance with the Constitution, or loss of good standing.
 - ✓ A written notice of termination is issued by the Executive Council after investigation.
 - ✓ The affected member is informed and given the right to respond before final approval.
 - ✓ The Secretariat updates records to reflect the termination.
-

SECTION 17.3 PROCESS OF APPLYING FOR OFFICE

- ✓ Eligible members submit written applications for positions within the Executive Council or committees.
 - ✓ Applications must meet minimum criteria, including membership in good standing.
-

- ✓ The Secretary verifies eligibility and circulates applications to the General Assembly before elections.
 - ✓ Voting follows the standard procedures outlined in Article 7.
-

SECTION 17.4 PROCESS OF RESIGNATION FROM OFFICE

- ✓ Office bearers wishing to resign submit a written notice to the Secretary or Chairperson.
 - ✓ The resignation is acknowledged in writing and communicated to the Executive Council and General Assembly.
 - ✓ Duties are handed over formally to the designated deputy or interim officer until replacement.
-

SECTION 17.5 DISCIPLINARY PROCESS

- ✓ Complaints or allegations of misconduct are submitted in writing to the Secretariat or designated complaints committee.
 - ✓ An impartial investigation is conducted by the Executive Council or a disciplinary committee.
 - ✓ The accused member is allowed to respond.
 - ✓ Findings are reported to the Executive Council, and appropriate disciplinary action is taken, including warnings, suspension, or removal.
 - ✓ Decisions may be appealed to the General Assembly.
-

SECTION 17.6 VOTING PROCESSES

- ✓ Voting may occur during General Assembly meetings, special meetings, or electronically where allowed.
 - ✓ Each member in good standing has one vote per issue.
 - ✓ Votes may be by show of hands, secret ballot, or electronic method approved by the Executive Council.
 - ✓ Decisions generally require a simple majority unless otherwise specified for constitutional amendments or major decisions.
-

SECTION 17.7 AMENDMENT PROCESS

- ✓ Any member, committee, or the Executive Council may propose an amendment (see Article 13).
 - ✓ Proposals are submitted in writing to the Secretariat, circulated to members, and discussed at a General Assembly.
 - ✓ Adoption requires a two-thirds majority of members present in the meeting.
 - ✓ The Secretariat updates the Constitution to reflect the approved amendment.
-

SECTION 17.8 REPLACEMENT OF DEMOTED OR VACATED LEADERS

- ✓ When a leader is removed, demoted, resigns, or is otherwise unable to perform duties, the Executive Council identifies eligible candidates.
 - ✓ A temporary acting officer may be appointed until a formal election or appointment is held.
 - ✓ Replacement follows the same procedures as election or appointment outlined in Article 6 and Article 17 (applying for office).
 - ✓ The Secretariat updates all records to reflect changes.
-

ARTICLE 18: SUPREMACY OF THIS CONSTITUTION

This Constitution guides all operations of the Human Dignity Foundation. All members, organs, programs, and decisions must follow it without exception.

SECTION 18.1 BINDING FORCE

- ✓ This Constitution binds all members, leaders, staff, volunteers, and partners.
 - ✓ No person or organ may act outside the rules in this document.
 - ✓ All actions, decisions, and policies must support the principles written here.
-

SECTION 18.2 HIERARCHY OF AUTHORITY

- ✓ This Constitution stands above all internal rules, guidelines, policies, and procedures.
 - ✓ When conflict appears between this Constitution and any internal document, this Constitution takes priority.
 - ✓ Decisions of the General Assembly follow this Constitution and cannot contradict it.
-

SECTION 18.3 COMPLIANCE REQUIREMENTS

- ✓ All members must follow the Constitution in their roles and activities.
 - ✓ The Executive Council monitors compliance and corrects any breach.
 - ✓ The Secretariat reports violations and takes steps to restore order.
 - ✓ Repeat violations lead to disciplinary action as guided by the Code of Conduct.
-

SIGNATURES OF ADOPTION

No.	Name of Signatory	Position/Role	Signature	Date
1		Chairperson		
2		Vice-Chairperson		
3		Secretary		
4		Vice Secretary		
5		Treasurer		
6		Public Relations Officer		
7		Vice Public Relations Officer		
8		Outreach and Partnership Officer		
9		Vice Outreach and Partnership Officer		
10		Welfare Officer		
11		Vice Welfare Officer		
12		Flame of Fairness Officer		
13		Vice Flame of Fairness Officer		
14		Founding Member		
15		Founding Member		
16		Witness		
17		Witness		

Instructions

- ✓ All office bearers and founding members must sign in the presence of witnesses.

- ✓ Dates of signing must reflect the actual adoption date of the Constitution.
- ✓ Witnesses must be independent and not hold conflicting interests.

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